

Actualyze AI

Category visibility, consolidation pressure and deployment eligibility - Gift #11

ACTUALYZE AI GIFT #11

The stronger question

Actualyze does not need another list of competitors. The useful question is whether the market surfaces that shape buyer discovery are already placing the AI Gateway category around it, before they place Actualyze inside it.

FACT

Actualyze sits between applications and inference and governs every request.

INFERENCE

The risk is not feature parity. It is being absent from the category surfaces buyers use before a demo.

The buying job we tested

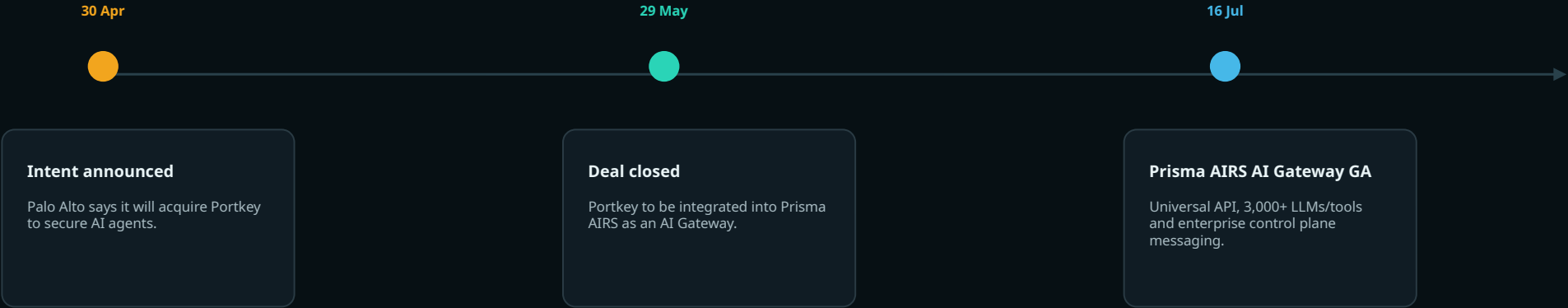
- 1 One governed path for every AI request
- 2 Policy, budget, guardrails and audit in the request path
- 3 Routing, fallback and multi-provider control
- 4 Deployment model acceptable to enterprise procurement

Decision exposure: category discovery, platform consolidation, deployment qualification.

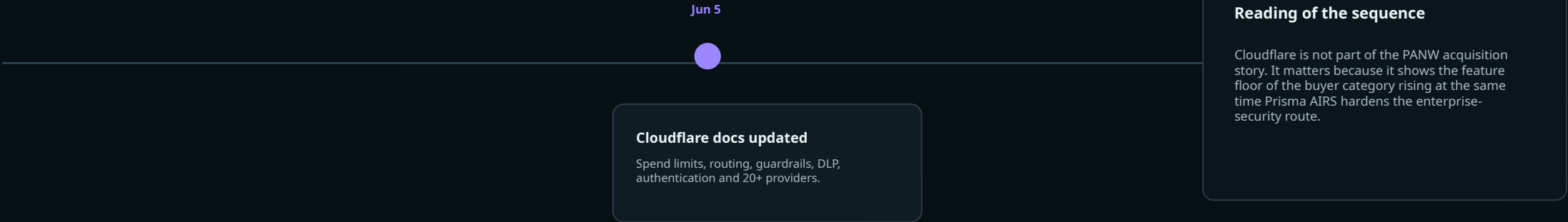
What changed

The timeline is split: Palo Alto / Portkey acquisition sequence and parallel category baseline pressure.

PANW / Portkey sequence



Parallel category pressure



Sources: Palo Alto Networks Apr 30 and May 29 releases; Prisma AIRS AI Gateway GA; Cloudflare AI Gateway features, last updated Jun 5 2026.

Finding 1 - Category visibility gap

This is the sharpened point: not “you have competitors,” but “buyer-discovery surfaces already define the category and do not visibly list Actualyze yet.”

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Actualyze product fit

FACT

Public site: one URL swap, OpenAI-compatible model path, budgets, policies, PII guardrails, routing, failover and chargeback. The homepage uses “control plane” and “foundation,” not “AI Gateway.”

This matches the buying job of an AI gateway even if the category phrase is not used on the homepage.

Buyer-category surfaces

OBSERVED

TrustRadius Best AI Gateways 2026 lists Prisma AIRS AI Gateway (Portkey) at #8 and Cloudflare AI Gateway at #13. Actualyze was not observed in the listed products during page scan.

Gartner Peer Insights AI Gateways shows products 1-20 of 27. Actualyze was not observed on the returned page scan.

Decision implication

INFERENCE

For a new enterprise buyer, the earliest shortlist may be shaped by directories, analyst-style pages and “best AI gateway” comparisons before any founder narrative lands.

The action is not to abandon “foundation for enterprise AI.” It is to test whether a secondary AI Gateway label improves discovery without shrinking the story.

Guardrail: absence from a directory is not evidence of lost pipeline. It is a category-discovery risk worth testing after launch.

Sources: Actualyze homepage; TrustRadius Best AI Gateways 2026; Gartner Peer Insights AI Gateways; page scan performed 30 Aug 2026.

EVIDENCE AXIS

Checked: 30 Aug 2026

Competitor snapshots

The founders already know the crowded field. The value here is where public buyer surfaces and procurement motion create pressure.

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Actualyze AI

Positions as “foundation for enterprise AI.” Sits in the request path and governs, secures, operates and optimizes calls across teams and models.

Prisma AIRS AI Gateway / Portkey

Security platform path. Portkey is folded into Prisma AIRS with Universal API, agent registry, semantic routing/caching and 3,000+ LLMs/tools.

Cloudflare AI Gateway

Developer/platform path. 20+ supported providers, routing, guardrails, DLP, auth and spend limits by model/provider/metadata.

AI Gateway / Control Plane buying job

False lead removed

R&D World already frames Actualyze as entering a crowded category and names Palo Alto/Portkey, Cloudflare, Kong and LiteLLM. Do not sell “we found your competitors” as the insight.

Sharpened value

The useful insight is external visibility and procurement framing: directories and buyer guides already define the category while security-platform consolidation changes the sale.

Finding 2 - Procurement path changed

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The important shift is not the acquisition announcement. It is the buyer question created after Portkey became part of Palo Alto Networks.

FACT base

- Palo Alto completed the Portkey acquisition on 29 May 2026.
- Prisma AIRS AI Gateway became generally available on 16 Jul 2026.
- Palo Alto states 70,000+ customers in its acquisition boilerplate.
- The AI Gateway offers Universal API, 3,000+ LLMs/tools and governance controls.

INFERENCE

The decision moves from standalone gateway comparison to security-platform consolidation.

For an enterprise already buying Palo Alto, the question may become: why add a new control-plane vendor instead of using the gateway inside the security platform we already operate?

Decision implication

Actualyze should not battle Prisma AIRS only feature by feature. It needs a clear case for why an independent AI control plane is worth a new vendor decision.

TEST COPY

"Vendor-neutral control across every model, not security-stack lock-in." This is a testable message, not a concluded claim.

Why this is founder-relevant: it changes the sales objection Actualyze may hear from security-led enterprises.

Finding 3 - Deployment eligibility gap

This is not just a feature gap. Deployment model is a buyer criterion in the AI Gateway category.

Actualyze today

FACT

Public material shows Hosted SaaS / Early Access now and On-Prem planned for 2027.

This may be fine for many early design partners. It is more fragile for buyers whose gateway evaluation starts with VPC, self-hosted or air-gapped requirements.

Comparator evidence

FACT

Portkey current Hybrid Deployment documentation shows Data Plane inside the customer VPC, keeping sensitive AI traffic and logs within the customer environment.

The same current Portkey property identifies Portkey as Prisma AIRS AI Gateway.

Buyer criterion

INFERENCE

If a regulated enterprise treats deployment model as a first-pass requirement, Actualyze can be procurement-blocked before routing, guardrails or budget controls are compared.

Action: separate “Hosted-fit ICP” from “private-deployment blocked ICP” until the 2027 on-prem path is real.

Attribution guardrail: VPC/Data Plane claim is sourced to Portkey documentation, not to Palo Alto product marketing.

Decision matrix

Same buyer pressure, not product parity. The matrix highlights where Actualyze may need sharper positioning or qualification.

Buyer question	Actualyze	Prisma AIRS / Portkey	Cloudflare AI Gateway	So what
Category visibility	Control plane / foundation; no AI Gateway language on homepage	Explicit AI Gateway and AI control plane	Explicit AI Gateway category language	Discovery risk
Buyer surface presence	Not observed on TrustRadius/Gartner AI Gateway lists checked 30 Aug	Listed on TrustRadius as Prisma AIRS AI Gateway (Portkey)	Listed on TrustRadius AI Gateways	Listing gap
Procurement path	New standalone vendor decision	Bundled into Palo Alto security platform path	Inside Cloudflare platform path	Vendor-add friction
Core controls	Budgets, guardrails, chargeback, routing/failover	Spending rules, runtime security, access controls	Spend limits, guardrails, routing, DLP, auth	Feature floor rising
Deployment model	Hosted now; On-Prem 2027	Portkey docs show Data Plane in customer VPC	Not assessed in this brief	Current gap
Best immediate action	Test category language and segment deployment-fit ICP	Build anti-consolidation battlecard	Keep as category-floor watch	Prioritize

Interpretation limit: this matrix does not claim feature parity. It tests where buyer discovery and procurement framing may weaken Actualyze’s position before a product evaluation.

Sources: Actualyze homepage; PANW/Portkey; Cloudflare features; TrustRadius; Gartner Peer Insights; R&D World.

Recommended watch actions

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Low-regret checks before paid conversion. These are framed as tests, not conclusions.

01

Run a category-copy test

Add a secondary phrase such as “Enterprise AI Control Plane / AI Gateway” to one controlled surface and track demo-intent quality against current copy.

02

Fix buyer-surface visibility

Submit or correct profiles in AI Gateway buyer directories where Prisma AIRS, Cloudflare, Kong and LiteLLM are already visible.

03

Build a Prisma AIRS battlecard

Focus on why vendor-neutral control is worth a new procurement path. Do not make it a generic feature table.

04

Segment deployment risk

Separate Hosted-fit prospects from VPC/self-hosted/air-gap prospects before discovery calls. Treat 2027 On-Prem as a qualification point.

Next paid question: Which ICP segment should Actualyze qualify out early because category visibility, security-stack consolidation or deployment requirements make the sale inefficient?